**Exploration rule** – Doors, locks and objects · SRD 5.2.1

A locked door, a sealed chest or a wall to break down is resolved with **ability checks** and the **object rules** (AC and HP). You can **pick** with thieves' tools, **force** with Strength or **break** through damage.

## 🎲 Quick summary:

1. Picking: **thieves' tools**, DC **15** (Dexterity).
2. Forcing: **Strength** check, DC 10 / 15 / 20.
3. Breaking: the object has **AC** and **HP**.
4. **Knock** opens without a check.

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## ⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 files these under the **Utilize** action and gives thieves' tools a default DC 15.

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## ⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say whether an object resists weapons or spells. Fix: an object is immune to **poison** and **psychic**; everything else damages it.

## 💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the noise: a creak that betrays intruders, or a quiet click.

## Step 1 – Examine:

Is the door closed, locked, barred or trapped? Clues are found with **Search**.

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## Step 2 – Pick:

**Utilize** action with thieves' tools: Dexterity check DC **15** (higher for an exceptional lock).

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## Step 3 – Force:

Strength check: DC 10 (rotten wood), 15 (standard door), 20 (reinforced door).

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## Step 4 – Break:

Attack the door: it has an AC and HP depending on its material.

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## Step 5 – Consequences:

Noise may alert guards; a failure may break the tool (**table rule**).

*Example: Ilsa picks a lock (DC 15): she rolls 17 and the door opens. Bryn bashes a wooden door: Strength 16 against DC 15.*

| Material | AC |
|---|---|
| Cloth, paper, rope | 11 |
| Crystal, glass, ice | 13 |
| Wood, bone | 15 |
| Stone | 17 |
| Iron, steel | 19 |
| Mithral | 21 |
| Adamantine | 23 |

## ⚠ Common questions:

### What DC to pick?

15, with thieves' tools.

### Do I need the tools?

Yes, otherwise the DM may refuse.

### What DC to force?

10, 15 or 20 depending on the door.

### Which action?

Utilize (an object).

### Does a spell open it?

Yes, Knock.

### Can I break down a door?

Yes, with attacks.

## ⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

### Broken tool

Does the tool break on a 1? **Option**: yes, spare tool.

### Help

Can an ally help? **Option**: yes with the Help action.

### Time

How long to pick? **Option**: 1 minute outside combat.

### Noise

Does forcing make noise? **Option**: yes, heard within 60 ft.

## ⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

### Thieves' tools

25 gp; default DC 15.

### Objects

Immune to poison and psychic.

### Magic lock

May require an Arcana check.

*These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.*

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